Xiaofei Wen

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Bio

CS Ph.D. student at University of California, Davis, advised by Prof. Muhao Chen.

Research focuses on reliable agents and multimodal models, examining whether benchmarks faithfully measure intended capabilities and developing generalizable, efficient methods for verifying policy compliance.

Publications

[a] When Vision Speaks for Sound May 2026

Huggingface page [#1 Paper of the day!]

Xiaofei Wen, Wenjie Jacky Mo, Xingyu Fu, Rui Cai, Tinghui Zhu, Wendi Li, Yanan Xie, Muhao Chen, Peng Qi

Preprint [paper] [webpage] [collection]

[b] Triaging Threats to Specialized Guardrails May 2026

Wenjie Jacky Mo*, **Xiaofei Wen***, Rui Cai, Boyu Zhu, Sicong Jiang, Zihan Wang, Minglai Yang, Zhe Zhao, Muhao Chen

Preprint [paper]

[c] Video Models Can Reason with Verifiable Rewards May 2026

Tinghui Zhu, Sheng Zhang, James Y. Huang, Selena Song, **Xiaofei Wen**, Yuankai Li, Hoifung Poon, Muhao Chen

NeurIPS 2026 [paper] [webpage]

[d] ModelLens: Finding the Best for Your Task from Myriads of Models May 2026

Rui Cai, Wenjie Jacky Mo, **Xiaofei Wen**, Qiyao Ma, Wenhui Zhu, Xiwen Chen, Muhao Chen, Zhe Zhao

NeurIPS 2026 [paper] [webpage]

[e] Robust and Efficient Guardrails with Latent Reasoning May 2026

Siddharth Sai, **Xiaofei Wen**, Muhao Chen

EMNLP 2026 [paper]

[f] Cooking Up Risks: Benchmarking and Reducing Food Safety Risks in Large Language Models April 2026

Weidi Luo, **Xiaofei Wen**, Tenghao Huang, Hongyi Wang, Zhen Xiang, Chaowei Xiao, Kristina Gligorić, Muhao Chen

Preprint [paper]

[g] DebugLM: Learning Traceable Training Data Provenance for LLMs Mar 2026

Wenjie Jacky Mo, Qin Liu, **Xiaofei Wen**, Wenxuan Zhou, Zhe Zhao, Muhao Chen

EMNLP 2026 [paper]

[h] OmniGuard: Unified Omni-Modal Guardrails with Deliberate Reasoning Dec 2025

Boyu Zhu, **Xiaofei Wen**, Wenjie Jacky Mo, Tinghui Zhu, Yanan Xie, Peng Qi, Muhao Chen

Preprint [paper] [webpage]

[i] Learning Efficient Guardrails for Compliance Oct 2025

Xiaofei Wen, Wenjie Jacky Mo, Yanan Xie, Peng Qi, Muhao Chen

ICML 2026 [paper] [webpage]

[j] REDCODER: Automated Multi-Turn Red Teaming for Code LLMs July 2025

Wenjie Jacky Mo, Qin Liu, **Xiaofei Wen**, Dongwon Jung, Hadi Askari, Wenxuan Zhou, Zhe Zhao, Muhao Chen

ACL 2026 [paper] [code]

[k] Diagnosing and Mitigating Modality Interference in Multimodal Large Language Models May 2025

Rui Cai, Bangzheng Li, **Xiaofei Wen**, Muhao Chen, Zhe Zhao

NeurIPS 2026 [paper] [code]

[l] ThinkGuard: Deliberative Slow Thinking Leads to Cautious Guardrails Feb 2025

Xiaofei Wen, Wenxuan Zhou, Wenjie Jacky Mo, Muhao Chen

ACL 2025 Findings [paper] [code]

[m] Red Teaming Language Models for Processing Contradictory Dialogues Nov 2024

Xiaofei Wen, Bangzheng Li, Tenghao Huang, Muhao Chen

EMNLP 2024 [paper] [code]

[n] Personalized Topic Selection Model for Topic-Grounded Dialogue Aug 2024

Shixuan Fan, Wei Wei, **Xiaofei Wen**, Xianling Mao, Jixiong Chen, Danyang Chen

ACL 2024 Findings [paper]

[o] Sequential Topic Selection Model with Latent Variable for Topic-Grounded Dialogue Dec 2022

Xiaofei Wen, Wei Wei, Xianling Mao

EMNLP 2022 Findings [paper]

Experience

Applied Scientist Intern, Amazon-Alexa – Bellevue, WA June 2026 – Sept 2026

- Mentor: Xiang Li, Chengyuan Ma
- Working on Audio-Video Model Agentic Native Detection

Research Intern, Codedroid – Milpitas, CA June 2025 – Sept 2025

- Advisor: Huan Ren
- Worked on a mobile LLM-based coding assistant (Cursor-like) for on-device development workflows.
- Built a pipeline to interpret user queries and localize file(s) in a code repository requiring changes.

Education

University of California, Davis Sept 2024 – Present

Ph.D. in Computer Science | GPA: 3.95/4.00

Huazhong University of Science and Technology Sept 2021 – June 2024

M.Eng in Computer Science | GPA: 3.90/4.00
Awards: First-Class Graduate Scholarship

Dalian University of Technology Sept 2017 – June 2021

B.Eng in Software Engineering | GPA: 3.89/4.00
Awards: Mitsubishi & Outstanding Scholarship; Meritorious Winner of 2019 ICM

Awards & Service

Uniphore Fellowship: Awarded $50,000 in fellowship support.

Amazon Nova AI Challenge: Member of UC Davis's CapitalAI team, which received $250,000 in research sponsorship.

Reviewer: NeurIPS, ICML, ICLR, ACL/EMNLP/NAACL, since 2023.

Vice President: Model United Nations of DUT, 2018–2019.